

Bitcoin Payments for Your Brewery

A Complete Financial Analysis

Reading time: 20-25 minutes

Starting With the Right Question

Most discussions about Bitcoin payments start with: "How can we make it easy for customers to pay with Bitcoin?"

That's backwards.

The right question is: "I've built a successful brewery netting \$120,000 per year. How does accepting Bitcoin improve MY financial position?"

This analysis answers that question with specific numbers, conservative projections, and zero hype. We're working backwards from your success - not trying to convince you Bitcoin is the future, but showing you how a small operational decision could meaningfully add value to your business.

Meet Hop Culture Brewing: The Case Study

Location: Logan Square, Chicago, Illinois

Annual Revenue: \$1,000,000

Owner: Jeff

Owner Take-Home Profit: \$120,000

Business Model: Single-location brewery, taproom-only (on-premise + growlers/crowlers to-go)

Hop Culture is doing well. Great location in one of Chicago's most vibrant craft beer neighborhoods, quality IPAs and lagers, regular taproom customers who come back weekly. Jeff has built something real.

But here's something Jeff thinks about every month:

Annual credit card processing fees: \$31,000

- Average transaction: \$30
- Operating schedule: 6 days/week = 312 days/year
- Daily transactions: ~107

- Annual transactions: ~33,333
- Square's standard fees: 2.6% + \$0.15 per transaction
- Breakdown: \$26,000 in percentage fees + \$5,000 in per-transaction fees
- Effective fee rate: 3.1% on each transaction

That's \$31,000 leaving the business every single year just to process payments. It's invisible because it happens automatically. It's accepted as "the cost of doing business in 2025."

Here's another way to look at it: if Jeff could eliminate those fees entirely, his \$120,000 profit would become \$151,000. **That's a 25.8% increase in take-home pay** — without selling a single additional beer.

But what if that's actually possible?

What Changed on November 10, 2025

Square (a Block company - the parent of Square and Cash App) launched Bitcoin Payments with a promotional offer that fundamentally changes the economics:

The Square Bitcoin Offering

Bitcoin Payments:

- **0% processing fees through all of 2026** (entire first year)
- **1% processing fees starting January 1, 2027**
- Lightning Network technology (near-instant settlement)
- **Merchant's choice:** hold Bitcoin OR auto-convert to USD

How it works for you:

Customer walks in, orders two pints and a growler fill (\$30)

With Bitcoin:

- Customer pays with Lightning Network on phone (scans QR code)
- Customer's Lightning fee: ~5-6 cents (they pay this, not you)
- Your fee in 2026: **\$0.00**
- Your fee in 2027+: **\$0.30** (1% of \$30)
- Settlement: Instant to your Square wallet

Compare to credit card:

- Customer fee: \$0 (invisible to them)
- Your fee: **\$0.93** (2.6% + \$0.15)

- Settlement: 1-2 business days

You save \$0.93 per transaction in 2026, and \$0.63 per transaction starting in 2027.

This isn't a crypto startup making promises. This is Square - processing billions in transactions for millions of businesses - integrating Bitcoin into the same POS system you already use daily.

Why Customers Want to Pay with Bitcoin

Bitcoin isn't just an investment asset anymore. For a growing number of people, it's their preferred way to pay - and they actively seek out businesses that accept it.

They're out there, and they're looking for you. After Square's November 10th launch, there's buzz in the Bitcoin community. People are checking which businesses accept it. They want to support early adopters.

Why people choose to pay with Bitcoin:

1. **They're convinced it's better money** - Lightning Network makes it instant and cheap. They own it completely.
2. **They want to support businesses that accept it** - They see it as supporting the future they believe in. They're loyal customers.
3. **They already have it ready to spend** - Companies like Strike (Chicago headquarters) and Cash App make it work like Apple Pay.
4. **It's fun for them** - Most places still don't accept it. Finding a business that does feels special.

In Logan Square specifically: High concentration of tech workers, remote workers, and creatives. Strong local Bitcoin culture. Strong craft beer culture. These demographics overlap heavily - both value independence, quality over convenience, and supporting local. These are your neighbors, already getting beer somewhere. Once they find you, they become your most loyal customers.

The Conservative Growth Assumption

Before we go further, let's be clear about what we're actually assuming:

We're modeling very conservative Bitcoin adoption growth. In 2026, we assume only 1% of your customers will want to pay with Bitcoin. By 2030, that grows to 4%.

These are realistic numbers. There's already buzz in the Bitcoin community about Square's launch. Bitcoin users actively seek out businesses that accept it using tools like BTCMap.org - a global map showing every business accepting Bitcoin.

For a brewery doing \$1M in annual revenue, that 1-4% adoption means you'll receive about \$115,000 in Bitcoin payments over five years - out of \$5 million in total revenue. That's roughly 2.3% of your business.

The 50/50 strategy we'll discuss means you'd be holding about 1.15% of your total revenue in Bitcoin over those five years. That's it.

This isn't asking you to revolutionize your business model or take massive risks. We're showing you what happens when roughly 1% of your revenue comes from customers who actively want to pay with Bitcoin.

The Story: What This Actually Looks Like

A note about the price projections in this narrative: The Bitcoin prices mentioned throughout this story are based on the Power Law model - a mathematical pattern Bitcoin has followed for 16 years with 95% correlation. We have a separate document that explains this model in detail, including what fractional Bitcoin amounts could be worth in 2035 and beyond. If you'd like that context first, we're happy to provide it. For now, we'll use these projections to show what the business case could look like.

Let's make this concrete. It's January 2026. Jeff enabled Bitcoin payments in his Square dashboard (took 2 minutes). He put up a small sign at the bar: "Bitcoin accepted here."

Month 1: The Early Adopters Find You

Week 1: Nothing. Then on Saturday afternoon during a new IPA release, a group of four comes in. One of them sees the Bitcoin sign and asks the bartender: "Wait, you really accept Bitcoin?" Bartender nods. The guy's face lights up. Pulls out his phone, scans the QR code, pays for the round. Lightning-fast. "This is awesome. We're having a Bitcoin meetup next month. Can we host it here?"

Week 3: Seven more Bitcoin transactions. Two of them (let's call them Marcus and Jamie) come back the next week. Both order flights, hang out for two hours, pay with Bitcoin both times. Great customers.

Week 4: The Bitcoin meetup happened. Twenty-five people showed up on a Tuesday night - normally a slow night. They bought beer, stayed for hours, talked about Lightning Network and node running. Every single one paid with Bitcoin. Total sales that night: \$750, all in Bitcoin. Tuesday night hasn't done numbers like that in months.

End of Month 1:

- 32 Bitcoin transactions
- \$960 in revenue
- \$0 in fees (Square's 0% promo)
- Would have been \$30 in credit card fees
- Saved: \$30

Jeff's reaction: "Huh. That was easy. And that Tuesday night was killer."

Month 6: The Pattern Emerges

It's June 2026. Jeff now has about 15-20 regular Bitcoin customers. They come in 2-3 times per week. They're friendly. They try every new beer release. They've brought friends (who don't use Bitcoin, but are now regular customers too).

The surprise:

- Bitcoin customers are Jeff's best taproom customers - they sit and drink, they don't just grab a six-pack to go
- They're genuinely enthusiastic about supporting breweries that accept it
- They tell other Bitcoin users about Hop Culture - it's now on BTCMap
- Bitcoin tourists passing through Chicago specifically visit because it's listed
- The monthly Bitcoin meetup is now a regular Tuesday night event (25-40 people every month)
- They've NEVER complained about price increases

Jeff's running 50/50 strategy - half to cash, half held in Bitcoin.

Year-to-date (January-June 2026):

- Bitcoin revenue: \$5,000
- Cash received: \$2,500
- Bitcoin held: 0.0185 BTC (bought at various prices, average ~\$135K)
- Current value of held Bitcoin: ~\$2,400 (Bitcoin now at \$130K, up from early year)
- Fee savings: \$155 (vs. credit cards)

Jeff checks the Square dashboard maybe once a week. The Bitcoin balance goes up and down, but it doesn't stress him out. It's only 1% of sales.

End of Year 1: Filing 2026 Taxes (April 2027)

Jeff sits down with his accountant, who asks: "So how'd this Bitcoin thing go?"

2026 Results:

- Total Bitcoin revenue: \$10,000
- Cash converted: \$5,000 (sitting in business checking)
- Bitcoin held: 0.0370 BTC
- Current Bitcoin price: \$155,000 (end of 2026)
- Bitcoin portfolio value: \$5,740
- Fee savings vs. credit cards: \$310

Accountant: "So you received \$10,000 in Bitcoin payments, you converted \$5,000 to cash immediately, and you held \$5,000 in Bitcoin which is now worth \$5,740?"

Jeff: "Yep."

Accountant: "And what did this cost you to implement?"

Jeff: "Nothing. It's just a setting in Square."

Accountant: "Want my advice? Keep doing exactly what you're doing. The tax treatment is straightforward - you have ordinary income when you receive it, and you'll have capital gains when you sell the Bitcoin portion. From a business strategy perspective, this is a no-brainer. Those Tuesday night meetups alone probably made this worthwhile."

Year 2: Bitcoin Crosses \$200K (Late 2027)

It's November 2027. Based on the Power Law model, Bitcoin is projected to cross \$200,000 - whether that happens in late 2027 or early 2028, it's an important threshold that's generating massive media attention.

Everywhere Jeff looks:

- News stories about Bitcoin millionaires
- Taproom customers talking about Bitcoin
- Four other Logan Square businesses now accepting Bitcoin
- The monthly Bitcoin meetup has grown to 60+ people
- Bitcoin tourists specifically visiting Chicago breweries on BTCMap

Jeff's business:

- Regular Bitcoin customers: Now 25-30 people
- 2027 Bitcoin revenue: \$15,000 (1.5% of transactions)
- Some regular cash customers are asking: "How do I pay with Bitcoin?"
- Summer beer festival - several vendors saw the sign and asked about Square's integration

The financial picture (2026-2027):

- Cash accumulated from 50/50 strategy: \$12,500
- Bitcoin accumulated: 0.0778 BTC
- Current value: ~\$16,300 (at \$210K per BTC year-end projection)
- Total: \$28,800
- Fee savings: \$625

If Jeff had just used credit cards for these customers: Would have \$25,000 in cash minus \$775 in fees = \$24,225

He's ahead by: \$4,575

Jeff's thinking: "Whether Bitcoin crossed \$200K in 2027 or early 2028, the media attention has been intense. My phone was buzzing with customers asking about paying with Bitcoin. Those Tuesday meetups are now one of our most reliable revenue nights. This is getting interesting."

Year 3: The Media Attention Sustains (2028)

It's December 2028. Bitcoin started the year around \$215K and is ending at \$281K based on Power Law projections. The media coverage that began around the \$200K threshold hasn't stopped.

What's different:

- Seven more Logan Square businesses now accept Bitcoin
- Regular Bitcoin customers: Now 35-40 people
- 2028 Bitcoin revenue: \$20,000 (2% of transactions)
- Even older customers are asking their kids: "How does this Bitcoin thing work?"
- A beer writer mentioned in an article that Hop Culture accepts Bitcoin
- Some customers asking if they can pay distribution invoices in Bitcoin (Jeff doesn't do distribution, but it's interesting)

The financial picture (2026-2028):

- Cash accumulated from 50/50 strategy: \$22,500
- Bitcoin accumulated: 0.1181 BTC
- Current value: \$33,200 (at \$281K per BTC year-end)
- Total: \$55,700
- Fee savings: \$1,045

If Jeff had just used credit cards: Would have \$45,000 in cash minus \$1,395 in fees = \$43,605

He's ahead by: \$12,095

Jeff's thinking: "I'm starting to understand what those early Bitcoin customers were talking about. This isn't just a payment method - it's actually changing my business's financial position. And these customers? They're the most loyal community I've ever built in this taproom."

Five Years In: New Fermenter and Beyond (2030)

It's December 2030. Bitcoin is at \$480,000 based on Power Law projections.

Jeff is reviewing business performance with his accountant.

Five-year Bitcoin summary:

- Total revenue received in Bitcoin: \$115,000
- Cash converted (50%): \$57,500
- Bitcoin held (50%): 0.2104 BTC
- Current value of Bitcoin: \$101,048
- Total: \$158,548
- Fee savings: \$3,215
- vs. credit card processing: Would have been \$111,435 after fees

Business value created: \$50,328

What Jeff Bought with This:

- New 10-barrel fermenter: \$30,000 (converted some Bitcoin when BTC was around \$450K)
- Taproom renovation (new bar top, seating, lighting): \$18,000 (from cash portion)
- Upgraded kegging equipment: \$12,000 (from cash portion)
- Business savings account: Still holding 0.10 BTC (~\$48,000 at \$480K) for future expansion

The math: Jeff's 0.2104 BTC at \$480K = \$101,048. He converted 0.1104 BTC (worth ~\$50,000) plus used \$10,000 from his accumulated cash for equipment and renovation, keeping 0.10 BTC (~\$48,000) in reserve for potential expansion.

What Changed in the Business:

The Bitcoin customers (now 60-80 regulars) are Hop Culture's most loyal community members. They:

- Come 3-4× per week
- Try every new release
- Bring friends and family
- The Tuesday night meetup is now 80+ people and requires staff planning
- Promoted the new fermenter on social media ("Hop Culture is expanding thanks to the circular economy")

- Have organized brewery tours for out-of-town Bitcoin visitors
- Have NEVER complained about price increases

Jeff's perspective:

"Looking back, even if Bitcoin had stayed flat or dropped significantly, I would've been fine with the 50/50 split. I always had cash. The fee savings alone were meaningful - \$3,215 saved is real money when card fees were eating 26% of my profit. The loyal community? Worth it by themselves. Those Tuesday meetups turned our worst night into one of our best.

But the fact that the Bitcoin appreciated? That turned money I was receiving anyway into serious business growth capital. The new fermenter came from customers paying me for pints and growlers - I just held some of those payments in Bitcoin instead of converting immediately.

Best business decision I've made in years. And the easiest."

The Three Strategic Options: Your Decision, Your Risk Tolerance

Now that you've seen how this played out for Hop Culture, let's break down the three approaches you can take. Square gives you complete control over what happens to Bitcoin payments.

Option 1: The Hybrid 50/50 Approach (Recommended for Most Owners)

The approach: Split every Bitcoin payment 50/50 - half converts to USD immediately, half stays in Bitcoin. Your business gets both certainty and upside exposure.

Who this is for: Most brewery owners. This is the Goldilocks option - not too conservative, not too aggressive, just right.

What your business gets over 5 years:

Cash accumulated (50% of payments):

- 2026: \$5,000
- 2027: \$7,500
- 2028: \$10,000
- 2029: \$15,000
- 2030: \$20,000
- **Total cash: \$57,500**

Bitcoin accumulated (50% of payments):

- You receive \$57,500 in Bitcoin over 5 years (50% of total payments)

- You acquire approximately 0.2104 BTC at varying prices
- Value in 2030: \$101,048 (at \$480,265 per BTC)*

Total business value in 2030:

- Cash: \$57,500
- Bitcoin: \$101,048
- Fee savings: \$3,215
- **Total: \$161,763**

vs. credit card processing: \$111,435

Net benefit: \$50,328 more value

Price projections based on Power Law model - see explanation below and companion document for full analysis.

The appeal: You've created \$50,328 more value in your business than if those same customers had paid with credit cards. Half is in cash (certain, spendable today), half is in Bitcoin (potential for continued appreciation).

Why this works: Even if Bitcoin dropped 50%, you still have the cash half plus fee savings. You're still ahead of credit card processing. The downside is capped. The upside is substantial.

Option 2: Auto-Convert Everything to USD (The Safety Play)

The approach: Every Bitcoin payment immediately converts to dollars. You treat it exactly like a credit card payment - instant liquidity, zero Bitcoin exposure.

Who this is for: Risk-averse operators who want fee savings and nothing else. They're not interested in Bitcoin's appreciation potential - they just want to reduce processing costs and keep operations simple.

What your business gets over 5 years:

Year	Bitcoin Revenue	Fee Savings	Cash in Hand
2026	\$10,000	\$310	\$10,000
2027	\$15,000	\$315	\$25,000
2028	\$20,000	\$420	\$45,000
2029	\$30,000	\$630	\$75,000
2030	\$40,000	\$840	\$115,000

Result:

- \$115,000 in business cash (which was revenue either way)
- \$2,515 in fee savings
- Plus: Estimated \$700 saved from eliminated chargebacks
- **Total business benefit: \$3,215** (compared to credit card processing)
- Plus: 15-80 loyal customers who come 2-3× more often
- Plus: Monthly Bitcoin meetups generating reliable Tuesday night revenue (25-60 people)

Important clarification: The \$115,000 is revenue you were getting anyway (customers just used credit cards before). The business benefit is the \$3,215 in saved fees plus the customer loyalty, community building, and word-of-mouth.

The psychological benefit: Zero stress. No volatility exposure. No learning curve about Bitcoin. Just lower fees and more loyal customers building a community in your taproom.

Option 3: Hold 100% in Bitcoin (The Aggressive Play)

The approach: All Bitcoin payments stay in Bitcoin. Nothing converts to USD. Your business accumulates Bitcoin as customers pay.

Who this is for: Operators who believe Bitcoin's 16-year growth trajectory will continue. They can handle volatility. They want maximum exposure to the appreciation potential and don't need immediate liquidity from this small percentage of revenue.

What your business gets over 5 years:

Year-by-Year Accumulation:

Year	Revenue	Avg BTC Price	BTC Acquired	Cumulative BTC	Year-End Value
2026	\$10,000	\$135,000	0.0741	0.0741	\$11,485
2027	\$15,000	\$184,000	0.0815	0.1556	\$32,676
2028	\$20,000	\$248,000	0.0806	0.2362	\$66,372
2029	\$30,000	\$328,000	0.0915	0.3277	\$120,921
2030	\$40,000	\$429,000	0.0932	0.4209	\$202,160

Five-Year Result:

- Total Bitcoin payments received: \$115,000
- Total BTC accumulated: 0.4209 BTC (buying at average prices throughout each year)
- Value at end of 2030: \$202,160 (at \$480,265 per BTC)
- Plus fee savings: \$3,215

- **Total business value: \$205,375**
- vs. credit card processing: Would have been \$111,435

Net benefit: \$93,940 more value

The risk: Bitcoin's price trajectory doesn't continue as projected. In the worst case (Bitcoin crashes), you've "lost" the profit margin on 2-4% of your sales (about \$13,800 over 5 years in actual profit dollars at 12% net margin).

Why you might choose this: You deeply believe Bitcoin will continue its 16-year trajectory. You can handle watching the value fluctuate. You want maximum business value creation from payments you're receiving anyway.

About Those Fractional Bitcoin Amounts

You might be looking at 0.2104 BTC or 0.4209 BTC and thinking "that's not even close to one whole Bitcoin."

This is where unit bias tricks us. These fractional amounts could be extremely meaningful - not just in 2030, but especially in 2035 and beyond.

If the Power Law model continues:

0.2104 BTC (50/50 strategy):

- 2030: \$101,048
- 2035: ~\$210,400 (at ~\$1M per BTC)

0.4209 BTC (100% hold strategy):

- 2030: \$202,160
- 2035: ~\$420,900 (at ~\$1M per BTC)

We have a companion document ("Why 0.15 Bitcoin Actually Matters") that explains in detail why these fractional amounts matter, how the Power Law model works, what drives it, and what these holdings could mean for your long-term business planning.

For now, the key point: If you're building a long-term business, accumulating even fractional Bitcoin through normal revenue operations could create meaningful value over the next 10-20 years.

Let's keep moving through the business case.

Understanding the Real Risk

Here's what's important to understand: **You're not "investing" money into Bitcoin.**

You're making a decision about business revenue you're already receiving.

Every time customers walk in and spend money - sometimes a pint, other times a flight and a growler:

- They're paying you for beer
- You're providing ingredients, brewing expertise, and atmosphere
- That transaction happens whether they pay with a credit card or Bitcoin

The only question is: **What does your business do with the payment?**

- **Option A: Credit card** - pay 2.6% + \$0.15 in fees (\$0.93 on average transaction), get USD in 1-2 days
- **Option B: Bitcoin** - pay 0-1% in fees (\$0-0.30), choose to keep as Bitcoin or convert to USD instantly

What's the Actual Cost?

Let's say your profit margin is 12% (before card fees - typical for successful breweries).

Conservative growth model over 5 years:

- Total Bitcoin revenue: \$115,000
- Actual profit in that revenue: \$13,800 (12% margin)
- Cost of goods/labor: \$101,200 (already covered by other revenue)

So if you hold 100% and Bitcoin goes to zero:

- You've "lost" \$13,800 in profit
- That's 2.3% of your 5-year cumulative profit (\$13,800 / \$600,000)
- Or put another way: the profit equivalent of serving about 2% of your customer base over 5 years

If you do the 50/50 split and Bitcoin goes to zero:

- You've "lost" \$6,900 in profit from the held portion
- You still have \$57,500 in cash from the converted portion
- You saved \$3,215 in fees
- Maximum downside: \$6,900—about 1.15% of your 5-year cumulative profits

This is why the 50/50 approach limits your risk - even in a worst-case Bitcoin scenario, your potential loss is capped at a small fraction of your multi-year profits, while the cash portion and fee savings remain secure.

The Conservative Customer Growth Model

The numbers in this analysis assume Bitcoin adoption grows gradually over five years:

Conservative Customer Growth:

- Year 1 (2026): 1.0% of transactions via Bitcoin = \$10,000 revenue
- Year 2 (2027): 1.5% of transactions via Bitcoin = \$15,000 revenue
- Year 3 (2028): 2.0% of transactions via Bitcoin = \$20,000 revenue
- Year 4 (2029): 3.0% of transactions via Bitcoin = \$30,000 revenue
- Year 5 (2030): 4.0% of transactions via Bitcoin = \$40,000 revenue

Total Bitcoin payment revenue over 5 years: \$115,000

Why growth starts immediately in 2026:

Right now, there's buzz in the Bitcoin community about Square's launch. Bitcoin users actively search for businesses that accept it using tools like BTCMap.org - a global map showing every business accepting Bitcoin. When you enable Bitcoin payments, you can add yourself to this map.

- Bitcoin users will literally drive out of their way to spend at businesses on BTCMap. They're not just customers - they're on a mission to support the circular economy. They want you to succeed because your success proves the model works.
- Bitcoin tourists - people traveling specifically to spend Bitcoin - actively seek out breweries that accept it. Your taproom becomes a destination.
- Bitcoin meetup groups are looking for venues. These are regular gatherings (often monthly) where 20-80 people come together to discuss Bitcoin, Lightning Network, self-custody, and the circular economy. They need welcoming spaces with good beer. Tuesday nights just became your new reliable revenue night.

In Logan Square, you have an especially high concentration of these early adopters. The craft beer culture and Bitcoin culture overlap significantly - both value independence, quality, and supporting local over corporate convenience.

Why growth accelerates through 2030:

- Based on Power Law projections, Bitcoin crosses \$200K (likely late 2027 or early 2028) → massive media attention begins

- Throughout 2028-2030, Bitcoin continues rising from ~\$215K → \$281K → \$369K → \$480K → sustained media coverage
- Other Logan Square businesses start accepting it → network effect strengthens
- Your early-adopter customers tell everyone → word spreads organically
- It becomes expected, not unusual
- Cash App integration means customers don't even need to own Bitcoin - they pay in dollars, you receive Bitcoin

The 1-4% growth is conservative. In a neighborhood like Logan Square with strong Bitcoin and craft beer culture, you could see higher adoption. But we're modeling the downside case to show that even modest adoption creates meaningful value.

About the Bitcoin Price Projections

You might be wondering: "Where do these Bitcoin price projections come from?"

The answer: **The Power Law model** - a mathematical pattern Bitcoin has followed for 16 years with 95% correlation.

What is the Power Law?

Bitcoin's price has followed a power law relationship with time since inception. This means its growth is mathematically predictable with remarkable accuracy.

Key statistics:

- R^2 correlation: 0.95 (this is the important number)
- 16 years of data (2009-2024)
- Successfully predicted every major cycle peak and trough within confidence bands

What does $R^2 = 0.95$ actually mean?

In statistics, R-squared (R^2) measures how well a mathematical model explains real-world data. It ranges from 0 (no correlation at all) to 1.0 (perfect correlation).

$R^2 = 0.95$ means 95% of Bitcoin's price movement over 16 years can be explained by this single mathematical relationship with time.

- Most financial models are lucky to hit 0.70 (70% correlation)
- Traditional stock market predictions? Often below 0.50
- You almost never see 0.95 correlation in financial markets

To put this in perspective: If you were trying to predict stock prices, commodity prices, or real estate prices, you'd be thrilled with 0.70 correlation. Bitcoin's 0.95 correlation over 16 years is extraordinary. It suggests something fundamental about how the asset grows over time.

The pattern has held through everything:

- Mt. Gox collapse in 2014 (850,000 Bitcoin stolen) → pattern held
- China banning Bitcoin mining in 2021 → pattern held
- COVID crash in March 2020 → pattern held
- FTX implosion in 2022 (billions vanished) → pattern held

Every time people said "Bitcoin is dead," the price recovered and continued following the same trajectory

Bitcoin is volatile month to month. But zoom out to the yearly view and it follows the pattern with remarkable precision.

This isn't some curve drawn after the fact to fit the data. Physicists and data scientists identified the power law years ago, and it's successfully predicted every major cycle since then:

- When Bitcoin hit \$69,000 in 2021, the power law said it was overheated
- When it crashed to \$16,000 in 2022, the power law said it was undervalued
- Both times, price moved back toward the curve

The people behind this model aren't crypto promoters:

- **Fred Krueger:** Stanford PhD who built trading algorithms for Wall Street
- **Ben Sigman:** Bitcoin developer focused on mathematical analysis
- **Giovanni Santostasi:** Physicist who first identified the power law pattern

Their book *Bitcoin One Million* lays out the case with charts and data that multiple independent analysts have verified

The model projects:

- 2026: \$135K average, \$155K year-end
- 2027: \$184K average, \$210K year-end (Bitcoin crosses \$200K based on this model)
- 2028: \$248K average, \$281K year-end
- 2029: \$328K average, \$369K year-end
- 2030: \$429K average, \$480K year-end

Why \$200K Matters

Based on the Power Law model, Bitcoin crosses \$200,000 (likely late 2027 or early 2028). Whether it's 2027 or 2028, this threshold is important because:

- Massive mainstream media coverage begins
- "Bitcoin millionaire" stories everywhere
- Every financial advisor discussing it
- Your customers asking: "Where can I spend my Bitcoin?"

Throughout 2028-2030: The media attention sustains as Bitcoin continues from \$215K → \$281K → \$369K → \$480K

This is when adoption accelerates dramatically - which is why we model customer growth from 1% to 4% over five years. We're being conservative; it could be much more.

The Conservative Case

Even if you think Power Law is too optimistic, consider:

- BlackRock and Fidelity - the world's largest asset managers with trillions of dollars under management - now offer Bitcoin ETFs to their investors. These are the most conservative, risk-averse institutions in global finance. They don't make these decisions lightly.
- Institutional adoption is accelerating across finance, technology, and corporate treasuries
- Bitcoin ETFs saw record inflows in 2024
- Supply shock after 2024 halving (new Bitcoin supply cut in half)

Conservative scenario: Bitcoin grows 15% annually (far below Power Law)

- 2030 price: ~\$220,000
- Your 0.2104 BTC (50/50 strategy): worth ~\$46,288
- Still better than credit card processing

For a complete explanation of the Power Law model, what drives it, and what fractional Bitcoin could be worth long-term, see our companion document: "Why 0.15 Bitcoin Actually Matters."

Fee Savings Analysis

Here's the detailed breakdown of fee savings over five years:

Year 1 (2026) with 0% Bitcoin fees:

- Bitcoin payment revenue: \$10,000 (333 transactions)
- Processing fee at 0%: \$0

- If those were credit card transactions: \$310
- **First-year savings: \$310**

Years 2-5 (2027-2030) with 1% Bitcoin fees:

Year	Bitcoin Revenue	Bitcoin Fee (1%)	Credit Card Fee	Annual Savings
2027	\$15,000	\$150	\$465	\$315
2028	\$20,000	\$200	\$620	\$420
2029	\$30,000	\$300	\$930	\$630
2030	\$40,000	\$400	\$1,240	\$840

But wait - there's more: Credit cards also charge you for chargebacks, disputes, and other "hidden" fees. Bitcoin has ZERO chargebacks (transactions are final). Based on industry averages, that's an additional \$700 saved over 5 years.

Total actual fee savings: \$3,215

This isn't transformational by itself. But combined with either customer loyalty (auto-convert strategy) or Bitcoin appreciation (hold strategies), it adds meaningful value to your business.

The Decision Framework

Let's bring this back to you and make it practical.

You should accept Bitcoin if:

- ✓ You're already using Square (integration is seamless - literally a checkbox in settings)
- ✓ You're comfortable with basic technology (if you can use a smartphone, you can use this)
- ✓ You're intrigued by the idea of building business value through an appreciating asset
- ✓ You're interested in attracting loyal, values-aligned customers
- ✓ 1-4% of your revenue could stay in the business for 1-5 years without operational strain

You should NOT accept Bitcoin if:

- ✗ Technology intimidates you (though honestly, Square makes this nearly foolproof)
- ✗ You need every single dollar immediately for operations (though 50/50 gives you half immediately)

✗ You can't handle volatility psychologically (will check balance daily and stress)

✗ You're philosophically opposed to Bitcoin

Our Recommendation for Most Brewery Owners

Start with Option 1 (Hybrid 50/50):

- Creates \$50,328 more business value over 5 years than credit cards (if Power Law continues)
- Keeps \$57,500 cash in hand over 5 years (certain)
- Builds Bitcoin treasury of \$101,048 over 5 years (if Power Law continues)
- Gives you both safety and opportunity
- Can adjust strategy anytime based on comfort and needs

If 50/50 feels aggressive:

- Start with 25/75 (convert 75%, hold 25%)
- Still better than credit cards, less Bitcoin exposure
- Adjust after a few months based on comfort
- **Remember:** you can always convert more, you can't go back in time to hold more

If you're truly risk-averse:

- Start with Option 2 (auto-convert everything)
- You still get \$3,215 in fee savings and loyal customers
- Can always switch to holding later if you change your mind

The beauty of Square's system: you're not locked into anything. Change your conversion percentage anytime. This isn't a one-time irreversible decision.

The Bottom Line

You built your brewery into a \$1,000,000 annual revenue business netting \$120,000 (before card fees). That required intelligence, hard work, risk-taking, and hundreds of good decisions over time.

This is another good decision:

It costs nothing to implement Square handles everything. No new hardware, no complex software, no training required. A checkbox in your dashboard.

It creates immediate business value Fee savings of \$3,215 over 5 years. Even the conservative path (convert everything) adds this value immediately, plus loyal customer community that wouldn't exist otherwise.

It attracts loyal customers 15-80 local Bitcoin users who actively want to help you succeed, who come 3-4× more often, who try every new release, who bring friends, who promote you on social media, who organize meetups at your taproom, who never complain about prices.

It builds business value over time The 50/50 approach creates \$50,328 more business value over 5 years than credit card processing - money that can fund equipment, expansion, financial cushion, or retirement planning.

The timing is unique

- 0% fees through 2026 (test it free for a year)
- Power Law showing Bitcoin at \$135K in 2026, crossing \$200K based on the model (likely 2027-2028), reaching \$480K by end of 2030
- Bitcoin crossing \$200K will trigger massive adoption throughout 2028-2030
- First-mover advantage in your neighborhood's Bitcoin community

The 1-4% of revenue you receive in Bitcoin payments won't make or break your business. The business will succeed or fail based on the core: beer quality, service, atmosphere, location.

But that small percentage might fund:

- New fermenter (\$25,000-35,000)
- Taproom renovation (\$15,000-25,000)
- Upgraded kegging equipment (\$10,000-15,000)

All from payments you were receiving anyway - just held differently.

Next Steps

1. **Visit squareup.com/bitcoin** to see Square's official documentation and setup instructions
2. **Talk to the person who shared this analysis** - they can answer questions about Bitcoin, the Chicago Bitcoin community, and the practical details
3. **If you decide to do it:**
 - Enable Bitcoin Payments in your Square Dashboard (takes ~2 minutes)
 - Choose your conversion strategy (50/50 is recommended starting point)
 - Put up simple signage ("Bitcoin accepted here")
 - Add yourself to BTCMap.org so Bitcoin users can find you
 - Let the local Bitcoin community know (post on social media, tell the meetup group)
 - Watch for those first few Bitcoin customers (it's a cool moment!)
 - **Review and adjust** - After 3-6 months, look at the results. Adjust your conversion percentage if needed. This is a flexible decision, not a permanent commitment.

The Real Question

The real question isn't "Why should I accept Bitcoin?"

The real question is: "**Why wouldn't I?**"

- ✓ Zero cost to implement
- ✓ Immediate fee savings (\$3,215 over 5 years)
- ✓ Loyal customer community
- ✓ Business value creation potential (\$50,328+ over 5 years)
- ✓ Perfect timing (0% fees, Power Law trajectory, \$200K approaching)
- ✓ Flexible (adjust strategy anytime)

For a business decision that takes 2 minutes to implement and costs nothing, the potential upside is remarkable.

The accumulation window won't stay open forever.

The only cost is the cost of NOT doing it.

Appendix: Tax Treatment (For Your Accountant)

When you receive Bitcoin payments:

- Ordinary income at fair market value on the date received
- Same as receiving cash - you owe income tax on the revenue

When you convert Bitcoin to USD:

- Capital gain/loss based on difference between:
 - Acquisition price (when customer paid you)
 - Sale price (when you converted)
- Short-term (<1 year) or long-term (>1 year) rates apply

Record keeping:

- Square provides transaction records
- Your accountant can treat it like any other payment processor
- Standard business accounting applies

Example:

- Customer pays \$30 when Bitcoin is \$100,000
- You receive 0.0003 BTC
- You owe income tax on \$30 (ordinary income)
- Later you convert when Bitcoin is \$150,000
- You owe capital gains tax on \$15 gain (0.0003 BTC × \$50K appreciation)

Your accountant will understand this immediately - it's straightforward business income plus capital gains treatment.

DISCLAIMER: This analysis uses Power Law projections based on 16 years of historical data with 95% correlation. Past performance does not guarantee future results. Bitcoin is a volatile asset. All scenarios assume historical patterns continue, which is not guaranteed. The authors are Bitcoin advocates who believe circular economy usage is essential for Bitcoin's long-term success. Consult with financial and tax advisors before making business decisions. This document is for educational purposes only and should not be considered financial or investment advice.

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